FAN DISCUSSIONS AND INTERACTIONS DURING THE 2026 FIFA WORLD CUP

SOCIAL WEB ANALYTICS INVESTIGATION USING BLUESKY DATA

INTRODUCTION & OBJECTIVES

The 2026 FIFA World Cup generated discussions among football fans on Bluesky. This project analyses fan engagement, popular discussion themes and interaction patterns to understand how users participated in World Cup conversations.

METHODOLOGY

Bluesky World Cup posts were collected and cleaned using R. We analysed likes, reposts and replies, compared Spain and Argentina engagement using a Wilcoxon test, identified discussion themes using TF-IDF and k-means clustering (k=4), and examined user interactions through a reply network.

CONCLUSION & LIMITATIONS

World Cup discussions on Bluesky covered football, national teams and politics. Engagement differed significantly between Spain and Argentina posts, while the reply network showed limited connectivity.

Findings are limited to the collected Bluesky sample and cannot represent all World Cup fans.

KEY FINDINGS & ENGAGEMENT

ENGAGEMENT OVERVIEW

1,750 cleaned Bluesky posts
16,118 likes
3,035 reposts
720 replies

SPAIN VS ARGENTINA

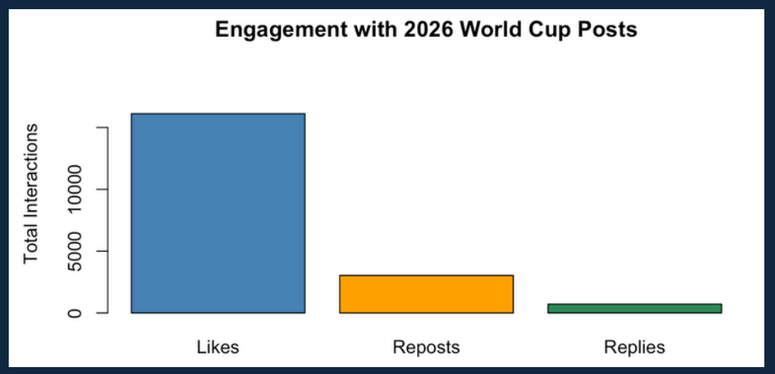
Spain: 339 posts, 23.59 mean likes
Argentina: 94 posts, 3.79 mean likes
Wilcoxon test: p = 0.007241
Significant difference in like distributions.

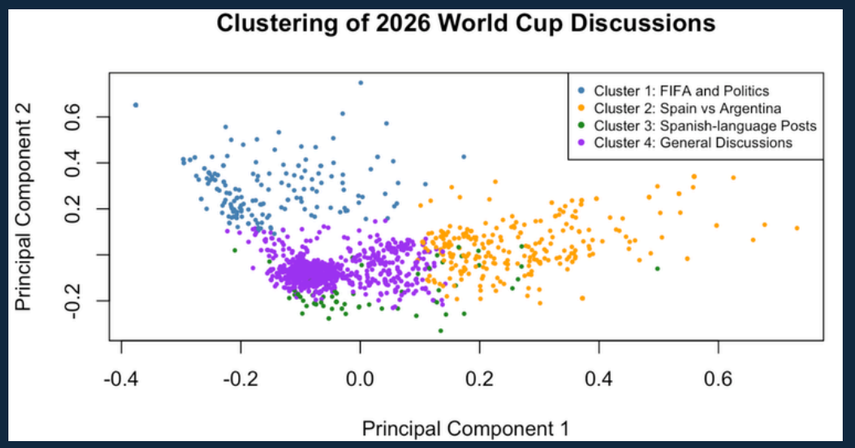
DISCUSSION THEMES

- General World Cup discussion: 62.12%
- Spain vs Argentina: 19.81%
- FIFA and politics: 12.72%
- Spanish-language discussion: 5.35%

REPLY NETWORK

55 users and 29 connections
26 weakly connected components
The network was sparse and fragmented, suggesting limited interaction between discussion groups.





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GitHub: github.com/affeyzak-blip/COMP3020-WorldCup2026-Analysis